Grab

Case Study 2026

SEPTEMBER 2026

The **45% GMV** uplift is real - but is it **SUSTAINABLE** ?

Cross-Sell Mega Promo | HCMC pilot | 6-week promotion

Observed GMV growth
>45%
Food + Mart in HCMC

Campaign mechanic
100K → 50K
Food threshold → Mart voucher

Promo period
6 weeks
Weeks 7–12

Decision
Scale?
Hanoi

Our question: did the campaign create durable Mart demand or temporarily buy GMV through incentive-driven behaviour?

1. Decompose the 45% uplift by users and transaction behaviour.
2. Test whether the uplift is economically healthy.
3. Use DiD / event-study to test whether Mart GMV persists after Promo.
4. Translate the evidence into a “Hanoi expansion decision”.

Cross-sell works, but `NEW MART` users are not the whole story

Acquisition funnel + New vs Existing Mart user decomposition

Food users	Voucher redeemers	Campaign acquired	New Mart users	Existing Mart
4,999	4,446	4,441	643	4,215
	89.08% of Food users	88.84% of Food users	13.24% of Mart users	86.76%

New Mart users = 13.2% of promo Mart users

Existing Mart users = 86.8% of promo Mart users

- Cross-sell acquisition is clearly effective: **88.84%** of campaign acquisitions are from Food users.
- However, New Mart users account for only **13.24%** of promo Mart users and **13.4%** of total Mart GMV.
- Therefore, New Mart acquisition alone cannot explain the headline Mart GMV uplift.
- This points us toward a second question: what happened to transaction behaviour inside the existing Food / Mart base?

The uplift is strongly associated with THRESHOLD-DRIVEN TRANSACTION BEHAVIOUR

Behavioural decomposition of the same tracked cohort

Metric	Pre-Promo	Promo	Change
Orders / user	8.14	19.15	**+135.3%**
GMV / user	1,088.9	2,210.0	**+103.0%**
AOV / order	130.2	118.2	**-9.2%**

Qualifying orders >100K

+162%

Pre → Promo

Users crossing threshold

5.8%

Below 100K → ≥100K

Orders INCREASE while AOV DESCREASE — the growth is not explained by simple basket expansion alone.

- Strong evidence of increased qualifying transactions around the 100K voucher threshold.
- Order splitting is a highly plausible mechanism; basket expansion / bundling still needs explicit item-level decomposition.
- The safer conclusion is: incentive-induced transaction expansion, rather than proven pure habit formation.

More GMV DID NOT TRANSLATE into healthier Mart economics

Contribution-margin view under the stated commercial assumptions

Mart GMV
1,383.7M → 1,792.1M
+29.5%

Margin / order
+4.5K → -25.0K
Material deterioration

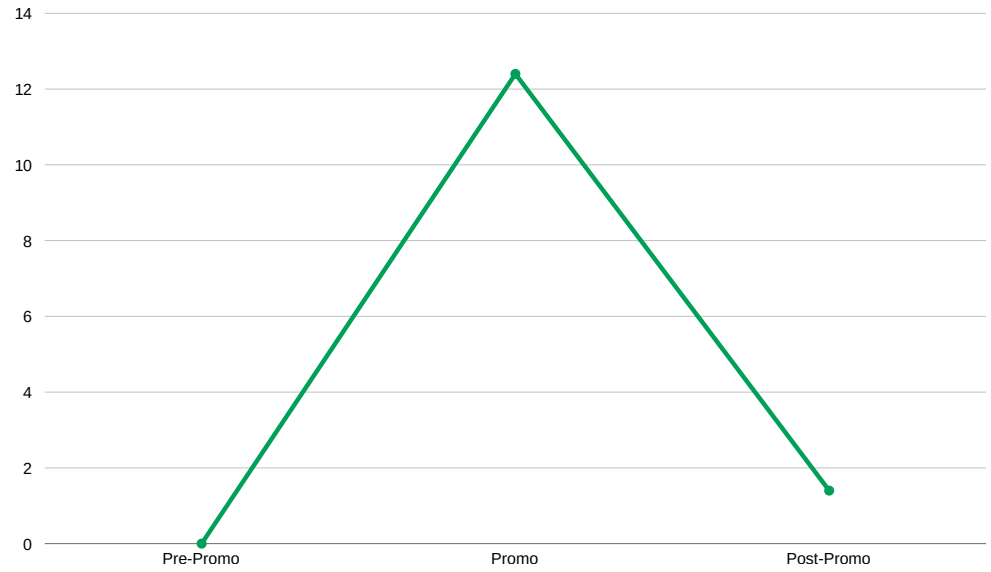
Total contribution margin
+64.8M → -590.6M
Pre → Promo

The campaign bought additional Mart volume, but the incremental volume was economically expensive.

- Mart orders increased from 14,517 to 23,630, while GMV increased from 1,383.7M to 1,792.1M VND.
- Under the stated assumption: gross revenue = item subtotal × take rate + delivery fee; direct cost = driver payout + promo discount.
- Promo-period Mart contribution margin turns negative, so GMV uplift should not be treated as equivalent to healthy incremental value.

Test sustainability: Mart GMV uplift fades after the promo

Difference-in-Differences / event-study using HCMC as treatment and Hanoi as the candidate control



Promo effect

Positive

Pooled DiD: preferred for P&L

Post-promo effect

Near baseline

2-week habit check

Event-study = more granular but noisier
Pooled DiD = one stable promo effect

Weather was considered as an external factor; HCMC–Hanoi temperature correlation was ~0.52 in the pre-period.

Final recommendation – Do not scale the current mechanic to Hanoi yet

The campaign can stimulate demand; it has not yet proven sustainable, healthy growth

THE CORE CONCLUSION: Incremental Mart GMV is real during Promo, but persistence and unit economics are not yet strong enough to justify scaling.

1 | DURABILITY
Weak evidence
Uplift declines toward baseline post-promo

2 | BEHAVIOUR
Incentive-driven
Orders +135%; qualifying orders +162%; AOV -9.2%

3 | ECONOMICS
Unhealthy
Mart CM turns negative under current assumptions

- Do not scale the current mechanic before proving that promo-acquired behaviour persists after the incentive is removed.
- Redesign the incentive to reward genuine incremental Mart adoption rather than incremental qualifying transactions.
- Next test: explicitly separate order splitting vs genuine basket expansion / bundling, then re-test post-promo retention and incremental contribution margin.

Decision: HOLD SCALE → OPTIMIZE MECHANIC → RE-TEST SUSTAINABILITY → THEN CONSIDER HANOI

Thank you for your listening